

SILK Fine, very long, lustrous fibres from the cocoons of various silkmoth species, notably the domestic silkmoth (*Bombyx mori*).

SILK HAT See *Top hat*.

SINGLE-BREASTED Men's coat or *jacket* that closes at the centre front with a single row of buttons; see also *Double-breasted*.

LATE 18TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.303, 447

SKINHEAD STYLE A style originating among young working-class British people, featuring close-cropped hair, *jeans*, and *Dr. Martens* boots.

LATE 1960s ▷

SKI PANTS Narrow-fitting, stretchy trousers with elastic straps under the insteps, first worn for skiing but then adopted as leisure wear.

20TH CENTURY: SEE P.346

SKORT Wide-legged shorts with a piece of fabric in front to give the appearance of a skirt.

20TH CENTURY ▷

SLACKS Loose, baggy casual trousers.

1920s ▷

SLASHES Decorative slits cut into the surface of a garment so fabric from an underlying garment can show or be pulled through.

1480s–1650s: SEE P.99

SLASH POCKET A horizontal pocket in a man's coat, with a slit opening and no covering flap.

19TH CENTURY: SEE P.453

SLEEVE-HAND The open end of a sleeve, where the hand emerges.

SLEEVE-HEAD The top of a sleeve, where it is attached to the *armscye*.

SLINGBACKS Women's high-heeled shoes with either open or closed toes and with a strap around the heel to hold them on.

1930s ▷

SLIP A women's light *petticoat*, worn under dresses or skirts.

20TH CENTURY ▷

SLIPPERS Lightweight, low-heeled shoes that can easily be slipped on and off, often used for indoor wear.

16TH CENTURY ▷

SLIP-SHOES Low-heeled *mules*.

16TH–MID-18TH CENTURY

SLIT POCKET A vertically cut pocket in a man's coat.

19TH CENTURY

SLOPPY JOE An oversized, loose-fitting *jumper*.

1950s ▷

SLOPS Very wide, loose knee-breeches often worn by sailors.

LATE 16TH–18TH CENTURY

SLUBS Thickened, irregular areas in *silk* fibre, often seen as an attractive feature in silk fabrics.

SMOCK A loose-fitting *linen* or *cotton* overgarment worn by labourers, often with a *yoke* and *smocking* patterns on the front; adopted as informal dress by women.

16TH CENTURY▷: SEE P.383

SMOCKING A decorative technique in which fabric is evenly gathered (see *Shirring*) and a pattern stitched on top of the *gathers*.

1880 ▷: SEE PP.205, 228, 241

SMOKING JACKET A short, *single-breasted* or *double-breasted jacket* for men, often in *velvet* or *silk* and lined with bright material, worn informally around the home.

1850s ▷

SNOOD (a) A fine mesh net worn by women to hold long hair or keep a hairstyle in place; (b) a tubular scarf pulled over the head.

19TH CENTURY ▷:

SEE P.197

SOLFERINO An *aniline dye* used to produce a fuchsia colour.

1860 ▷



SOMBRERO A traditional Mexican hat with a wide, upturned brim and a slightly pointed crown.

SEE PP.121, 438

SPAGHETTI STRAPS Very thin, light straps, often seen on women's sundresses, evening dresses, and undergarments.

20TH CENTURY ▷

SPANDEX A trade name for a light, elastic fibre used in underwear, tights, and swimwear; see also *Lycra*®.

1958 ▷

SPANGLES Small disks or lozenges of shiny metal with pierced centres, sewn on to garments for decoration; see also *Sequins*.

LATE 15TH–LATE 19TH CENTURY

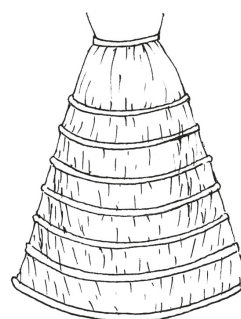
SPANISH CLOAK Originally a short, hooded cloak for men; later, a man's short evening cloak lined with brightly coloured *silk*.

16TH–EARLY 20TH CENTURY

SPANISH FARTHINGALE

The earliest form of *fartingale*, a garment that originated in Spain; made with a series of hoops that widened towards the feet, giving a funnel-shaped skirt.

c.1520s–1620s: SEE PP.432–3

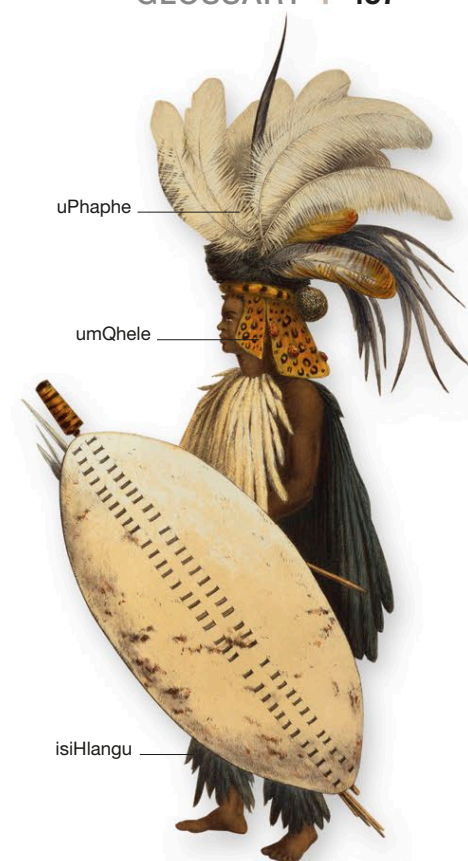


SPATS Cloth or leather coverings for the uppers of men's shoes, worn by the military and as formal wear.

19TH–EARLY 20TH CENTURY: SEE PP.263, 442

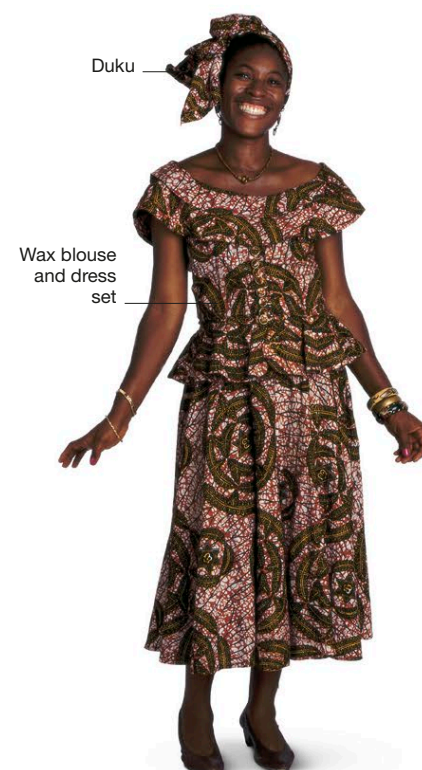
SPENCER (a) A short, double-breasted men's *jacket*, often worn for country pursuits; (b) a short, close-fitting, high-waisted jacket worn by women in the Regency era, over an *Empire-line dress*; (c) a *wool* or *wool mix* vest or thermal garment worn by women.

18TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.171, 174, 187



Zulu warrior, South Africa

The rank of a Zulu warrior is indicated by the wearing of particular animal hides and feathers. The leopard-skin *umQhele* headress is worn by those of high status.



Ghanaian woman in typical dress

Said to have been introduced to West Africa by European traders in the 19th century, *wax*, or *batik*, is a textile used widely in West African traditional dress.